ZOE GEYMAN

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SUMMARY

Qualitative researcher with 10+ years of experience across federal contract research, international fieldwork, and academic research, now applying that expertise to consumer and market insight work. Skilled at moderating interviews and focus groups, designing studies and discussion guides, and translating complex findings into clear, client-ready narratives. Background in stakeholder relationship management, proposal development, and presenting research to specialist and non-specialist audiences alike.

SKILLS

Qualitative Research & Insight: Live moderation (1:1 and group), discussion guide design, semi-structured interviewing, focus group facilitation, thematic coding (NVivo, Dedoose), data-driven reporting

Client & Stakeholder Relationships: Partnership development, rapid rapport-building with skeptical or resistant interlocutors, multi-stakeholder relationship management, steady communication under pressure

Communication & Storytelling: Plain language writing, audience-tailored translation, technical writing, oral presentation

Research Operations: Grant and proposal writing, project management, budget tracking, research operations

Languages: French and Italian (classroom study), Hindi (intermediate)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Washington University in St. Louis St. Louis, MO

Doctoral Researcher & Instructor *2018–Present*

- Coordinated research partnerships with two universities and NGOs in Delhi, conducting semi-structured interviews and ethnographic fieldwork while managing multi-stakeholder relationships across 12 months in the field
- Built rapport with a wide range of interlocutors, including officials and community members who were initially wary or resistant to engaging with outside researchers, sustaining productive relationships throughout fieldwork
- Presented research at national and international conferences and summits, including the American Anthropological Association, Society for Applied Anthropology, and the Fulbright India Summit, engaging both specialist and non-specialist audiences

- Taught 8 courses including 2 as instructor of record, developing expertise in making complex research clear and engaging for audiences without specialist training
- Authored technical narratives and planned and managed budgets for two competitively awarded research grants, including a nationally competitive Fulbright-Hays Doctoral Dissertation Research Award and Washington University's Summer Graduate Research Fellowship
- Supervised and mentored 3 research assistants, providing structured feedback and supporting their professional development

American Institutes for Research Washington, D.C.

Research Assistant *2016–2018*

- Designed and executed qualitative data collection across multiple projects, including focus group facilitation, semi-structured interview protocol development, field visits, and survey design
- Wrote plain language summaries of disability and education research, translating complex technical findings into clear, accessible deliverables for federal clients and community stakeholders
- Synthesized complex research findings into clear, client-ready deliverables including technical reports and presentations for diverse audiences
- Managed stakeholder and partner relationships across multiple simultaneous projects, ensuring prompt communication, tracking deliverables, and maintaining collaborative relationships with federal clients and institutional partners
- Contributed to proposal development across multiple federal and state bids, drafting technical narrative sections and supporting budget development
- Co-authored two peer-reviewed scoping reviews published in applied research journals

Centre for Environment Education Ahmedabad, India

Research Fellow *2015–2016*

- Led data collection on international experiences of gender inequality and translated findings into a report presented at the 2016 U.N. Commission on the Status of Women
- Developed proposals for a community-based participatory research project and provided editorial support for the Journal of Education for Sustainable Development

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Cultural Anthropology 2026

Washington University in St. Louis | Fulbright-Hays Doctoral Dissertation Research Award, 2022–2023

- *Dissertation examines how consumption and taste practices among NGO employees shape perceptions of international development status, proposing an alternative framework for measuring program impact.*

M.A., Cultural Anthropology 2020

Washington University in St. Louis | Summer Graduate Research Fellowship, 2020

B.A., Cultural Anthropology 2015

James Madison University